

Eight people looking for **one right car**

Buyer personas for the approved-used matcher, across its two anchor retailers: who these people are, what they say they want, and what actually decides it. Research-informed working personas, July 2026, with every source audited and scored for trust, and every persona replayed against the anchor retailer's live stock. One of the eight is here because he leaves.

BMW · Grassick's of Perth

DO

Daniel, 47

The Motorway Manager

PS

Priya, 38

The Family Consolidator

MH

Martin, 56

The Reward Buyer

TB

Tyler, 27

The First-Premium Striver

MINI · Sytner Luton, plus the one who leaves

CB

Chloe, 29

The Statement Buyer

SJ

Sam & Jordan, 34

The Fun-Sized Family

MW

Meg, 58

The Electric Downsizer

RJ

Rob, 41

The Whole-Market Shopper

THE CONTEXT

What the research says about used-car buyers

~14 hrs

of online research before a buyer contacts anyone, peaking in the evening

What Car? survey via Wonderful.co.uk · confidence: medium

40–50 mi

the working radius buyers shop in; nearly half say they'd go further for the right car

Auto Trader marketplace data · confidence: medium-high

60%

of under-35s' research happens on a phone; over-45s still skew desktop

Meta UK via Wonderful.co.uk · confidence: medium-low

88%

call colour a key purchase factor, even though most end up in white, black, grey or silver

Axalta global colour survey · confidence: medium-high

The journey is online-first; the purchase stays local. People do the work in the evenings on their own sofa, then buy from a dealer they can reach, inside a radius of roughly forty to fifty miles. The matcher is built for exactly that shape: it is a per-retailer tool, each deployment anchored to a single retailer's stock and honest about what sits just beyond it. This pack covers two live deployments, Grassick's of Perth for BMW and Sytner Luton for MINI. The BMW personas shop the first one's radius, the MINI personas the second's; nobody shops both.

Affordability is the mood. Most buyers budget in monthly payments rather than totals, and younger buyers barely think in any other unit. **Taste decides late:** people narrow to a shortlist on facts, then choose between near-identical cars on colour and character.

The brands attract different people. BMW's approved-used buyer is established, 35–55, and buys certainty: warranty, history, no surprises. Approved used is also the brand's front door for the next generation, which is what Tyler is here to represent. MINI's buyer skews younger, urban and image-led; the Countryman exists so young families don't have to trade the statement away.

Evidence honesty: every source behind these numbers was fetched and audited on 22 July 2026; each carries the confidence score shown, and two travel-distance statistics from an earlier draft were withdrawn when their claimed source turned out not to contain them. The full audit table, with what each source was used for and why it earned its score, is in docs/personas.md. These personas are synthesised from that research plus brand positioning and this project's stock analysis; they are hypotheses to test, not interview findings.

"I've had company cars for ten years. This one's my own money, so it needs to be right."

LIFE

Regional operations director, outside Perth. Married, two teenagers.

MILES

~22,000 a year, mostly A9/M90

BUDGET

£22–38k, and he thinks in monthly outgoings too

SHOPPING FOR

Diesel or plug-in hybrid saloon/estate

TRIGGER

Company car goes back on a fixed date in November, found or not

MONEY

Cash allowance plus savings; no part exchange (the old car is the fleet's)

DEVICE

Desktop, evenings, spreadsheet in the next tab

SAYS HE WANTS

A comfortable, frugal motorway car. Diesel by habit; hybrid-curious but no home charger yet.

ACTUALLY DECIDES ON

Total cost of ownership and the absence of doubt. First private purchase in a decade, which makes him the classic Approved Used customer: he is buying the warranty and the history as much as the car. He will read every line of both.

WHAT WINNING HIM OVER LOOKS LIKE

A sensible high-mileage answer with the economy argued in his terms: what this car costs to run at his mileage, and the programme's certainty stated where he can see it rather than assumed.

Checked against live stock, 22 July 2026: a 91% match, 520d M Sport Touring, led with the economy reasoned at his mileage; the plug-in he is curious about was visible as runner-up. Served.

"If the buggy and the dog don't both fit, it doesn't matter how clever it is."

LIFE

GP in Perthshire. Two children under 8, one spaniel. Going from two cars to one.

MILES

~9,000 a year + Glasgow grandparent runs

BUDGET

£25–45k · wallbox already on the drive

SHOPPING FOR

Electric or plug-in SUV/estate

TRIGGER

The second car failed its MOT in June; the household goes to one good car

MONEY

Surviving car in part exchange; the rest on a PCP she budgets monthly

DEVICE

Mobile in stolen moments; decides on desktop with partner

SAYS SHE WANTS

An electric family car big enough for everything, safe, and honest about range.

ACTUALLY DECIDES ON

Whether she believes the boot claim (she thinks in buggies and dogs, not litres), ISOFIX in the back, what the range really is on a cold motorway run to Glasgow, and, buying used electric, what the battery has left: its state of health and whether its warranty carries over.

WHAT WINNING HER OVER LOOKS LIKE

A shortlist she can defend to her partner: practicality reasons front and centre, honest numbers, and nothing that smells like it is hiding a compromise.

Checked against live stock, 22 July 2026: a seven-way tie at 95%, iX2s and X1 plug-ins all meeting the brief. Served, with friction: near-identical cards, and a stronger match 23 miles away the page never mentioned.

"I've spent thirty years being sensible. Not this time."

LIFE

Sold his share of an engineering firm. Kids gone. Promised himself this for twenty years.

MILES

~6,000 a year, sunny ones

BUDGET

£30–60k

SHOPPING FOR

Petrol convertible, quick enough to feel it

TRIGGER

The firm sale completed in spring; the money is being sensible and shouldn't be

MONEY

Cash. A 5 Series on the drive that may or may not go in part exchange

DEVICE

Desktop; will phone the dealer rather than fill in a form

SAYS HE WANTS

A petrol convertible. He is decisive about the shape and open-minded about almost everything else.

ACTUALLY DECIDES ON

How it makes him feel: the sound, the colour on his gravel drive, the test drive. Will happily travel fifty miles for the right car.

WHAT WINNING HIM OVER LOOKS LIKE

Being told straight. If the right car isn't at his local dealer, say so and say where it is; he has the time and the tank to go and get it.

Checked against live stock, 22 July 2026: no convertibles at Grassick's, and the tool said so, pointing at the nearest 18.1 miles away with a 94% Z4 leading the carousel. Served: he is the honesty this design was built for.

"My mates rate the badge. My bank app rates the monthlies. Both have to say yes."

LIFE

Software sales, Dundee.
Commission just starting to land.
First premium car.

MILES

~12,000 a year, commute plus weekends

BUDGET

£16–24k on paper; really a monthly number and an insurance quote

SHOPPING FOR

Petrol 1 Series or 2 Series Gran Coupé, M Sport, black or white

TRIGGER

First full commission quarter banked in July; the Fiesta's MOT is due by Christmas

MONEY

~£2k deposit, a part exchange worth barely £1k, ~£300 a month before insurance. Insurance is the ambush

DEVICE

Phone only, late night, YouTube and TikTok reviews running

SAYS HE WANTS

The M Sport look for the money he has. He knows the exact trims and the exact engines; the reviewers he trusts have opinions on both.

ACTUALLY DECIDES ON

The monthly payment his bank app tolerates and the insurance quote it doesn't. Then the colour in his building's car park. Approved used is his way into the badge, even if nobody markets it to him that way.

WHAT WINNING HIM OVER LOOKS LIKE

The right car with numbers he can say out loud: the monthly, the insurance group, the 0–62. Zero friction; one whiff of brochure-speak and he's gone.

Checked against live stock, 22 July 2026: an 85% match M135i in Alpine White, his exact car in his colour. Served on the match; his sharpest asks (the monthly, the insurance group) are still on the tool's gap list.



Chloe Bennett, 29

The Statement Buyer

MINI

“It's the first car I've bought with my own money. It's not allowed to be boring.”

LIFE

Marketing manager in Luton, in London three days a week.

MILES

Low; city and station runs

BUDGET

£14–22k · budgets monthly, not in totals

SHOPPING FOR

Petrol 3-door hatch · it's a MINI or a Fiat 500

TRIGGER

Hit her savings target in June; the deposit fund is finally the size she promised herself

MONEY

Own deposit, a decided PCP monthly, no part exchange. Money is the second gate; colour is the first

DEVICE

Entirely mobile, 9pm, Pinterest board open

SAYS SHE WANTS

A 3-door petrol MINI hatch. Classic trim is fine.

ACTUALLY DECIDES ON

The colour and the roof. Full stop. The one that photographs best outside her flat wins.

WHAT WINNING HER OVER LOOKS LIKE

Getting to make the final call herself, between real cars whose paint she can see, not being told which one is "best" by a spreadsheet.

Checked against live stock, 22 July 2026: a six-way Cooper tie in five visible colours, with colour chips to break it. Served: the stock can actually give her the choice she is here for, which was worth proving rather than assuming.



Sam & Jordan Reyes, 34

The Fun-Sized Family

MINI

“Having a kid doesn't mean we have to drive something grey.”

LIFE

Graphic designer and paramedic in Luton. One toddler, an allotment, street parking.

MILES

Town miles plus weekend escapes

BUDGET

£18–30k

SHOPPING FOR

Countryman or Clubman, petrol (no charger on their street)

TRIGGER

The toddler kit outgrew the old three-door this spring; the buggy goes in sideways

MONEY

Three-door in part exchange, small shared deposit, a monthly stress-tested against shift pay

DEVICE

Mobile, in shifts, sending each other links: “this one?”

SAY THEY WANT

A practical MINI: buggy-and-shop boot, cheap to run, still theirs to look at.

ACTUALLY DECIDE ON

Whether the buggy fits with the weekly shop, doors that open in tight car parks, and the styling still saying MINI, which the contrast roof carries.

WHAT WINNING THEM OVER LOOKS LIKE

Practicality they believe, in their own terms, from a car that still looks like theirs in the photos.

Checked against live stock, 22 July 2026: five Countrymans met the brief, and their plug-in curiosity was honoured honestly: none at Sytner Luton, nearest 21.9 miles away, leading the worth-the-drive carousel. Served.



Meg Whitlow, 58

The Electric Downsizer

MINI

"I don't want clever. I want honest, comfortable, and a plug."

LIFE

Recently retired teacher, St Albans. Downsizing from an X1 that's too big for her life now.

MILES

Short: town, garden centre, grandchildren

BUDGET

£15–25k · wallbox fitted last spring

SHOPPING FOR

Small electric automatic, comfortable

TRIGGER

The X1's insurance renewal and a big service quote landed the same week the wallbox went in

MONEY

The X1 in part exchange covers most of it; savings top up the rest. Would rather not finance

DEVICE

Desktop, daytime, methodical. Prints things.

SAYS SHE WANTS

A small electric car with a plug she already has. Not a badge purchase; the MINI is simply the charming version of the right size.

ACTUALLY DECIDES ON

Trust. Range said plainly, heated seats and parking sensors present, an automatic gearbox confirmed rather than assumed, a dealer she can reach, a warranty page she reads twice, and what the battery has left in it: state of health, and whether its warranty transfers to her.

WHAT WINNING HER OVER LOOKS LIKE

Plain numbers, no cleverness, and the comfort equipment stated where she can see it.

Checked against live stock, 22 July 2026: two identical-spec MINI Electrics, Chili Red versus Midnight Black, with chips offering exactly that choice. Served, one gap: nothing told her they are automatic. They all are; she doesn't know that.

"Why would I take a recommendation from the bloke selling the car?"

LIFE

Project manager outside Perth.
Three tabs open; the retailer's
own site holds the fewest cars.

MILES

~14,000 a year, family duty plus
commute

BUDGET

Under £25k, judged against the
whole market

SHOPPING FOR

3 Series Touring, petrol or diesel;
not fussy about the badge if the
numbers are better elsewhere

TRIGGER

None he'd name. Permanently
half in the market; a price-drop
alert converts him

MONEY

Part exchange plus a modest
deposit; dealer finance only if it
beats his bank loan, and he will
check

DEVICE

Desktop and phone; saved
searches and alerts on everything

SAYS HE WANTS

A tidy 3 Series Touring under £25k. He knows what the same car
costs forty miles away and what the aggregators call a good price.

ACTUALLY DECIDES ON

Price against the whole market. A single retailer's stock is a
sample, not a market, and he treats it that way.

WHY HE LEAVES

The moment the tool recommends rather than filters. A matcher
operated by the seller is a sales instrument, and he assumes it
ranks on margin, not on fit. He is not wrong to assume that.

WHAT WOULD KEEP HIM

The tool saying "we do not have the right car for you this week"
when that is true. A tool that will admit a miss earns the right to be
believed on a hit. Martin gets a version of this as tone; Rob needs
it as a system property.

Not yet replayed against stock. His answer set is in the fixtures; his
verdict turns on whether the tool will admit a miss, which two of its
five result states exist to do.

THE EMPHASIS

Where the volume sits

Personas without weights invite over-investment in whoever is most fun to design for. These estimates exist so the build order can be argued with. **Every number on this page is an assumption**, held to the same standard as the source audit: labelled, low confidence, and waiting to be replaced by the retailer's own enquiry logs and sales data. Treat differences of five points as noise.

BMW · Grassick's of Perth

PERSONA	ENQUIRIES (EST.)	UNITS (EST.)	GROSS PER UNIT	FINANCE USE
Daniel	20%	30%	Medium-high	Medium
Priya	25%	30%	Medium	High
Martin	5%	5%	Highest in the set	Low: cash
Tyler	35%	25%	Low-medium	Highest in the set
Rob	15%	~5%	Low when he buys	Low

MINI · Sytner Luton

PERSONA	ENQUIRIES (EST.)	UNITS (EST.)	GROSS PER UNIT	FINANCE USE
Chloe	45%	40%	Medium	High
Reyes	30%	35%	Medium-high	High
Meg	15%	20%	Medium	Low: part exchange plus savings

Residual shares are buyers this pack deliberately does not model (trade, export, sub-£14k). Two readings worth stating: Tyler enquires the most and converts the least, so his share of enquiries must not be read as share of value. And the work he needs, numbers up front with zero friction, is also what keeps Rob on the page, so that effort double-counts.

How to falsify this page: pull twelve months of enquiry logs and DMS sales records for each retailer, classify a sample of enquiries against the persona set, and replace every estimate above. Any persona claiming volume that the logs cannot find should be demoted from the build order, however well it interviews.